personality traits.' Modi's supporters reject the Nandy thesis. As one of them told me, 'Modi is a karma yogi, a remarkably hard-working politician with a human touch and communication skills who has consistently fought and won over adversity. He represents the triumph of Indian democracy.'

This is not an appropriate time to either demonize or deify Narendra Modi. His prime ministership is, after all, work in progress. What is certain, though, is that Verdict 2014 has placed India at the cusp of change, with the future direction pregnant with a range of possibilities, good and bad. If a Congress under Nehru ushered in India's republican Constitution, a BJP led by Modi could well redefine the idea of India, or at least the way it is governed.